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Resurrection of Christ
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All the epistle readings from Pascha to Pentecost are from the Book of the Acts of the Apostles. The Acts gives us a history of the foundation of the Church and tells how it was established among people of different races, opinions, and degrees of knowledge. It is a manual both of the missionary labor and of Church doctrine and discipline. Standing between the Gospels and Epistles, it helps us to see how the holy life of Christians has its source in the life of Christ.

In the very beginning of the book, St. Luke states that he intended it to be a continuation of his gospel. He writes in 1:1 "the former treatise I have made..." The Book of Acts follows the spread of Christianity from Jerusalem to the establishment of the Church in Rome and St. Paul's going there as a prisoner. In between, we read of the Church spreading to Palestine, Antioch, Galatia, Macedonia, Greece and Asia.

The book was written before the martyrdom of St. Paul in Rome, for it ends before his death. It is believed that it was written sometime between 62 AD and the middle of the second century. (from the Orthodox Herald)

Св. Жены – Мироносицы

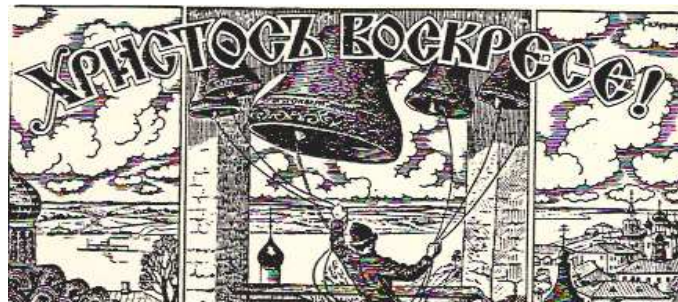
"По прошествии субботы, Мария Магдалина и Мари Иаковлева и Саломия купили ароматы, чтобы идти помазать Его."
(Мк 16:1)

История Воскресения Иисуса Христа открывает трогательную преданность жен-мироносиц. Они первыми сподобились величайшей чести – увидеть воскресшего Господа. И именно к ним первым обращено то великое слово, которое составляет духовный нерв всего Евангелия – радуйтесь! Ведь христианство – это религия любви и радости. Жены-мироносицы, своей преданностью, своей любовью к Спасителю первыми удостоились чести увидеть Его после Воскресения. Они рассказали о величайшем чуде другим ученикам. Жены-мироносицы для самих апостолов стали первым апостолами, потому что апостол – это тот, кто благовествует о Воскресении Христовом. Известно высокое значение женщин в деле распространения христианства. Святые мученицы поражали современников не одной глубокой верой, но и самым возвышенным целомудрием. Хочется обратить внимание еще на один отрадный факт, который открывается при внимательном чтении святого Евангелия. Ни одна женщина не участвовала в гонениях на нашего Спасителя при Его земной жизни. Сколько

**Sunday, Apr 26, 2026
Divine Liturgy Sundays at 9:30 AM
Confessions before Liturgy**

**Myrrh-bearing women
Мироносицы жены**

ненависти, хулы, клеветы, злобных преследований было против Господа нашего Иисуса Христа. Все это привело нашего Спасителя на Голгофу. Но ни в одном из этих эпизодов не участвует женщина. Фарисеи и книжники, знавшие каждую букву Писания, не признавали Иисуса Мессией, а простая женщина-самарянка уверовала в Него как во Христа и проповедала это всем жителям города Сихарь. (Иеромон. Иов Гумеров)



The Myrrhbearing Women,

St Joseph of Arimathea and St. Nicodemus

The Myrrh-bearing women, along with St Joseph of Arimathea and St. Nicodemus are commemorated on the third Sunday of Pascha.

Although St. Thomas was commemorated the previous Sunday, it is still right that the descendants of Eve should be the first to behold the Resurrection and to hear the joyful tidings concerning it. Therefore we remember the Myrrh-bearing women on this Sunday because they were the first to truthfully bear witness to the Resurrection; and Joseph and Nicodemus, because they were the first to bear witness to Christ's burial.

We know both of these facts through the tradition of the Church. Nicodemus was immediately banished from the synagogue by the Jews and was forbidden to rejoin them. And Joseph was thrown into a deep pit by the Jews, but by the grace of God he was delivered from it, and went to his estate in Arimathea. Joseph could not keep silent regarding these events and boldly taught all the people what had taken place regarding Jesus. And also it is said that Nicodemus was the first to proclaim in detail what had occurred at the Passion and the Resurrection of Christ. Since he was one of the foremost in the council of the Jews and a Pharisee, he knew firsthand the councils and plots of the Jewish leaders and all that had come to pass

regarding the Lord. Thus we commemorate on this Sunday Saints Joseph and Nicodemus and the Myrrh-bearing women because they are true and authentic witnesses of the burial.

The women are titled “Myrrh-bearers” because they purchased expensive ointments and oils, and came to the tomb while it was still night, in order to properly anoint Christ’s body and to complete all that had to be omitted due to the hurried manner of His burial. The burial was hurried because the Friday on which Christ was buried was the day before the Passover, and Joseph and Nicodemus did not have sufficient time to properly anoint the body according to custom. They were able only to apply some aloes and a bit of myrrh before wrapping It and laying It in the tomb. When the women came after Passover to complete the burial properly, they became the first witnesses to Christ’s Resurrection. (*excerpted from the Synaxarion*)

Смертию смерть поправ

Что это за удивительный тропарь величайшего из праздников, столь дорогой для нас и столь непонятный для нехристиан, вызывающий даже их насмешки?

Огонь может ли быть потушен огнем? Тьма может ли просветиться тьмой? Зло может ли быть побеждено злом? Конечно нет.

Подобное подобным не уничтожается, а только противоположным. Огонь угашается водой, тьма разгоняется светом, зло побеждается добром.

И тем не менее вопреки этому всеобщему закону Христос Своею смертью поправ смерть.

Какую смерть? Духовную смерть. Ту смерть, сущность которой есть отчуждение от Христа Бога, Который есть Любовь, Путь, Истинна и Жизнь. Духовная смерть есть отвержение пути добра, любви и истины и предпочтение ему другого пути – пути зла, ненависти и лжи. А этот путь от диавола, врага Христова, ибо он есть отец лжи, ненависти и зла. Итак, духовнаш смерть от диавола.

Эту смерть поправ Христос безмерным и неиссякаемым потоком любви Божественной, излившимся с Креста Голгофского. Ненависть диавола к роду человеческому побеждена любовью Божией к нему.

Trampling Down Death by Death

What is this wondrous troparion of the greatest of feasts—so dear to us, yet so incomprehensible to non-Christians that it even provokes their mockery? Can fire be extinguished by fire? Can darkness be illumined by darkness? Can evil be vanquished by evil? Of course not.

Like is not destroyed by like, but only by its opposite. Fire is quenched by water; darkness is dispelled by light; evil is overcome by good.

And yet, contrary to this universal law, Christ, by His own death, trampled down death.

Which death? Spiritual death. That death whose essence is alienation from Christ God—Who is Love, the Way, the Truth, and the Life. Spiritual death is the rejection of the path of goodness, love, and truth, and the preference for another path in its stead—the path of evil, hatred, and lies. And this path originates from the Devil, the enemy of Christ, for he is the father of lies, hatred, and evil.

Thus, spiritual death comes from the Devil. Christ trampled down this death with an immeasurable and inexhaustible torrent of Divine love that poured forth from the Cross of Golgotha. The Devil’s hatred for the human race was vanquished by God’s love for it

Homily on Thomas’s Test

*“My Lord and my God”
(John 20:28)*

When the Apostle Thomas felt the wounds of the Lord Jesus, he cried out: *My Lord and my God!*

When Mary Magdalene heard the voice of the Resurrected One in her soul, she cried out: *My Lord and my God!*

When Saul sat the light and heard the words of the Resurrected One, he acknowledged: *My Lord and my God!*

When the pagans, in amazement, observed how countless numbers of martyrs joyfully underwent pains and asked them Who this Christ was, all of them replied: *My Lord and my God!*

When the scoffers ridiculed the army of ascetics and asked them Who He was for Whom they took upon themselves the awesome burden of asceticism, they all had one answer: *My Lord and my God!*

When the scorners derided the virgins who had vowed their virginity and asked them Who He was for Whom they had renounced marriage, they all had one answer: *My Lord and my God!*

When the avaricious, in astonishment, asked the wealthy for Whose sake they had distributed their wealth and become beggars, all of them had the same reply: *My Lord and my God!*

Some have seen Him and have said: *My Lord and my God!*

Some have only heard Him and said: *My Lord and my God!*

Some have only felt Him and said: *My Lord and my God!*

Some have only observed Him in the fabric of events and in the destinies of people and said: *My Lord and my God!*

Some have felt His presence in their lives and cried out: *My Lord and my God!*

Some have recognized Him by some signs, to themselves or to others, and cried out: *My Lord and my God!*

Still some have only heard about Him from others and believed and cried out: *My Lord and my God!*

Truly, these last ones are the most blessed!

Let us also exclaim, with all our hearts, regardless of how we have come to recognize Him or learn about Him: *My Lord and my God!*

To thee, O God, be glory and praise forever. Amen. (*from the Prologue of Ohrid*)